



China game release freeze

The Online Games Ethics Committee in China has not approved any new video game releases since March 2018. <https://dgit.in/jan19-55>



Next Pokemon movie

The next Pokemon movie 'Mewtwo Strikes Back Evolution' has been announced and will be released in July 2019. <https://dgit.in/jan19-56>

Pic-a-boo!

I hate bandwagons,
and everyone who
jumps on them

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

H

ow often have we been warned / warned others that posting things on the internet is forever? I

know I've told a fair share of people that the silly stuff they do online might well come back to haunt them. With social media research being a legitimate HR tool to find the right people for a job, watching what you do online is imperative. We can all thank Facebook for that, though, in fairness, it was coming sooner or later. Once the biggest use of the internet stopped being piracy and porn, and it became a serious tool to be used for work, the desire to be known was always going to win over the desire to do stupid stuff anonymously. If it wasn't Facebook that did it, it would have been something else instead.

The popularity of, well, attempting to be popular, is not to be undervalued. Now that we all have got a taste of it, it's not going anywhere. However, there still is something to be said for being anonymous, and even better, if you can not be anonymous, but at the same time not be held to ransom for your past. Basically, if Facebook (and the internet as a whole) was more permanent, then there was a need for something to be ephemeral to offer balance. Many assumed Twitter was that, and for many people, it's enough. However, it relies on wit and one-upmanship, which are not traits all of us are blessed with.

What we are all blessed with is otherwise embarrassing bits of our bodies that someone or the other out there is interested in seeing in an uncovered way. What's worse, most of us are also cursed with the desire to show off said embarrassing bits to those others, in the hope of them reciprocating in kind.

This is how an app called Picaboo was born in 2011, which we now know as Snapchat. What started as a bunch of college pervs trying to find a way for people to securely share nudies with one another ended up becoming an anti-Facebook movement, or rather, an

nence for their content, and Facebook now has 'stories' (also LinkedIn and YouTube, etc). This stories thing is like a disease that is spreading across applications – what's next? fitness tracking apps sharing training routines, stories on Uber so riders can share how awesome or awful their trip was, or sharing your favourite clips with friends as a story?

The problem is, people on different platforms are so programmed into thinking permanence, that they just don't know how to use ephemeral tools. Even if they did, when you

have built up a list of family, friends and colleagues on Facebook, you're certainly not going to share frivolous Snapchat-like content on there. What on earth LinkedIn is doing with a stories feature I have no idea.

It is far worse for Snapchat users though, because as the company is pressured to make money in an environment of advertisers that is used to

Facebook-style targeting, it is diluting its core competency. This will result in the introduction of permanence into a place where young people have gotten used to being safe despite being idiotic, and that's not going to go well at all! If only tech companies would stop jumping on to bandwagons we might actually have an internet experience we want, but the mad dash for profits at all costs will never allow it. Boo bandwagons! 🙄



#LAME

anti-the-internet-is-permanent movement by young people who didn't want to be judged forever by the stupid stuff they did when they were young. All very well and good, until...

...the mad dash to clamber breathlessly on to a bandwagon begins. Facebook tried to buy it and was rejected, which resulted in Instagram becoming a kind of Snapchat killer. The result was that Snapchat had to change towards bringing in more perma-